



**Peek under the hood of the most popular search engine there is,
and learn how to use it effectively**

Finding a needle in a haystack may sometimes be easier than finding relevant search results on the Web. But with Google, you can refine your searches dramatically. It's the definitive search engine that can be used to scour the Internet for virtually anything—from a simple search for MP3s to issues such as Digital Rights Management, Google is sure to bring up results of relevance. Though most people are satisfied with typing in whatever they want and clicking search, power users need more. To get accurate results, you have to use certain tricks to properly link all sections of your query.

To search better, you have to know what to query for and more importantly, how the technology works.

Every Web site uses certain keywords to describe itself. These keywords are included in the code of the Web site and are called Meta tags. Most search engines compare these keywords to the query you enter, in order to check the relevance of the page. This process of checking a page is known as Web crawling. The problem with Web crawling is that Web sites can make improper use of Meta tags. Commonly generated search requests such as money, news and jobs are added as keywords to almost every Web site.

Google uses many search algorithms, and a large network of low cost PCs, to filter its results. The main algorithm used is PageRank, which votes for the relevance of a site. Each site that provides a link to the tested site is counted as a vote. Also, the vote of an important site is given higher priority. After this, a separate algorithm known as Hypertext is

used, which makes a detailed comparison of all the elements of the tested Web page. After this, the results are delivered to your system.

Google's advanced technology is all well and good, but the main question is "How do I search better?" All you have to do is follow some simple search tactics to get better results.

Understanding Your Google

When you perform a query, it appears in the Google page at the top. Below this, you will see some categories, which indicate that your query is listed in the Google directory. Then the results are displayed in the order of relevance. If your search uses very general terms, you may get hundreds of thousands of results. Thus, the best search is one that gives you fewer, but more accurate results.

If you use Google regularly, you may have noticed the 'I'm Feeling Lucky' button, located right next to Search. Clicking on this button will take you directly to the most relevant Web site—the first link that would appear if you had clicked on Search. If the query is related to an organisation, you will also see a stock quote of the company. Three more links are included with every result—'Cached', 'Similar Pages' and 'More results from...'. The 'Cached' link allows you to view a snapshot of a Web site, taken when Google indexed the site. The snapshot may not provide the current version of the page, but is extremely useful if the

Web site in question is out of service. The 'Similar Pages' link allows you to view page listings that are similar or related to the query, and the 'More results from...' allows you to see search results from other Web sites.

The most basic aspect of query construction is clear thinking. You must be specific in your thinking of what you want to search for before typing in the keywords. A specific query will generate more accurate results than a query with commonly found keywords. For example, if you're searching for the lyrics of a song, try typing in a line from the song along with its name.

Google eliminates all common words such as 'The', 'And' or 'Of'. This is done because such words generate a lot of results. But if you are searching for 'Rise Of Nations', the 'Of' is necessary. To specifically include it, you have to search for 'Rise +Of Nations' or include the query in quotes—search for "Rise of Nations".

Another way to improve your search results dramatically is to use the Advanced Search feature. This allows you to construct your query with a variety of conditions. You can also provide exclusions to your



Refine your search result using the Advanced Search Options